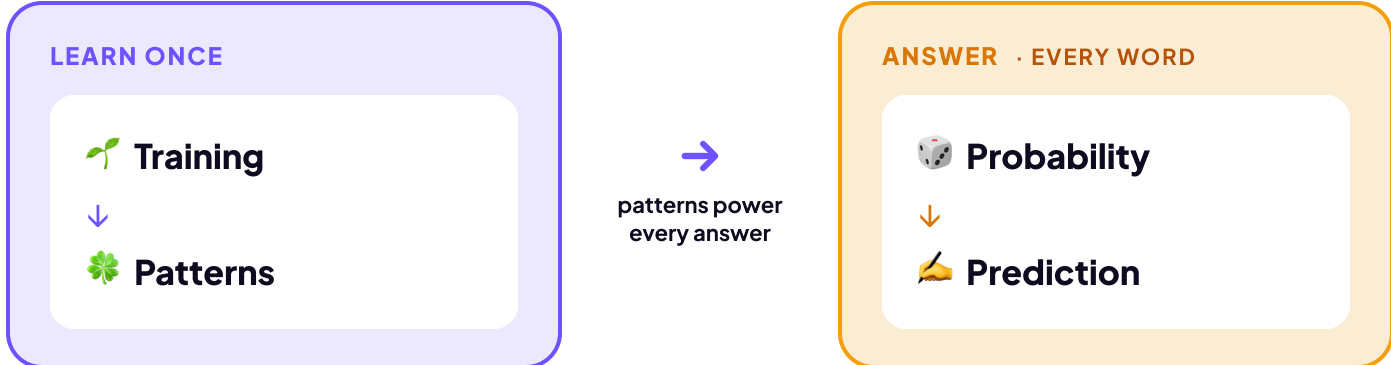


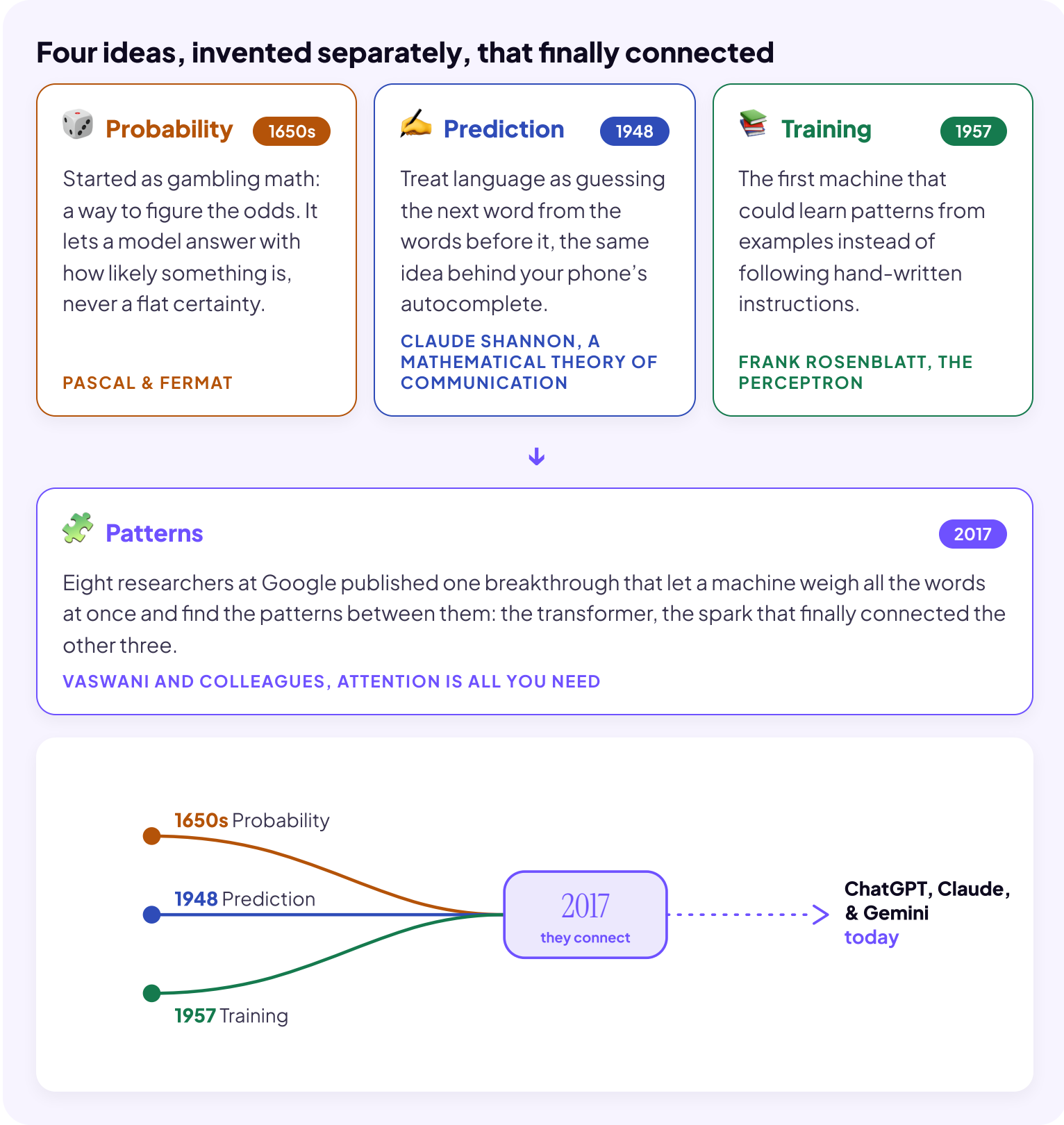
How We Got Here

AI can feel like it appeared out of nowhere, fully formed, almost like magic. It didn't. What looks like one sudden invention is really four older ideas, each worked out by different people who weren't trying to build AI at all.

You already met those four ideas in How an LLM Works. Here's how they come together: four separate breakthroughs that finally connected at the single moment everything changed.



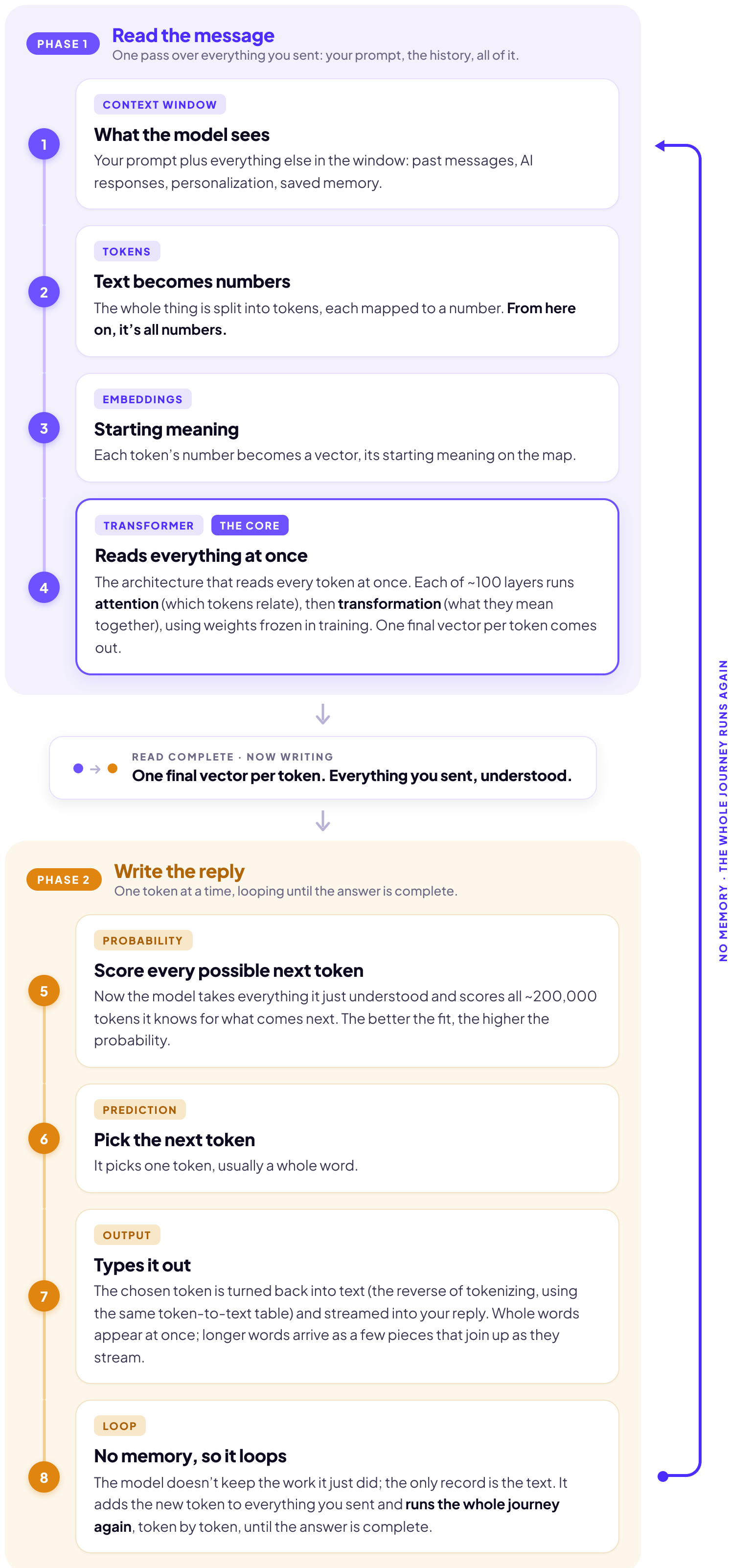
None of them arrived together. Each was figured out decades, even centuries, apart, for reasons that had nothing to do with AI.



THE MACHINE, END TO END

And those four ideas didn't just connect once. They run, in order, every time you hit send. Here's the full journey your prompt takes through the machine this course taught you to read.

Here's the whole journey in one picture, from your prompt to a finished answer. **It runs in two phases, and the end feeds back to the start.**



None of this was magic.

It was steps, stacked over time.